

What is a Sacrament?

Sacraments are a visible sign of an invisible reality. They give grace.



*"The word was made flesh, and dwelt among us."
- John 1:14*



Activity Title

Match the sacrament with the grace given through it.

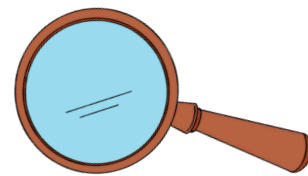
Baptism	Empowers the priest or deacon to live out his vocation well.
Confirmation	Deepens our love for God and neighbor.
Eucharist	Helps us live out the Creed and believe in God.
Reconciliation	Helps married people live out their vocation better.
Anointing of the Sick	Encourages the suffering to endure their trial.
Matrimony	Gives us strength to endure persecution and profess Christ.
Holy Orders	Helps us resist sin and evil.



Did You Know?

The Council of Trent states: "If any one saith, that the sacraments of the New Law were not all instituted by Jesus Christ, our Lord; or, that they are more, or less, than seven, to wit, Baptism, Confirmation, the Eucharist, Penance, Extreme Unction, Order, and Matrimony; or even that any one of these seven is not truly and properly a sacrament; let him be anathema."

Reflection Questions



Pause to reflect on the Sacraments

Which of the sacraments have you received so far? What was that experience like? Do you have any core memories from receiving a particular sacrament?

Is there a sacrament that you haven't received yet that you are looking forward to? Which one is it? What graces are you excited to enjoy?

Response of Thanksgiving

Use your reflections to guide a prayer to God.

When Jesus incarnated, he set us up with physical signs of his power and love through the Seven Sacraments of the Catholic Church. Take a moment to thank him for these seven miracles of grace we have access to in his Church.

Guided Imaginative Prayer

Follow the prompt to enter into imaginative prayer with God.

Imagine you are sitting in your pew at Mass. You are watching the priest raise the holy host above his head, when suddenly his appearance transforms and you see Jesus at the altar in his place. Flash forward and you are in the confessional receiving absolution. The priest's voice changes and you recognize the voice of Jesus forgiving you. Flash forward and it's your wedding day. You and the spouse of your dreams are kneeling at the altar and Jesus is marrying you. Flash forward to a hospital room. You are really sick. The doctors have tried everything. Jesus comes to your hospital room to anoint you personally. Notice how the sacraments feel different when you know their graces are coming to you through Jesus.



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